

Word family: **whole / wholly / wholeness**

Base word: whole

Related forms: wholly, wholeness

Useful extensions: whole-hearted / wholehearted, wholeheartedly

Useful expressions: the whole thing, the whole time, as a whole, on the whole, a whole lot, make whole, whole number, whole food

Part of speech: adjective (形容詞) / noun (名詞) / related adverb and noun family (相關副詞及名詞)

Your sentence:

> “He does not just play with toys; he creates **whole worlds** around them.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **whole** means:

> **complete and fully imagined, rather than consisting of only a few isolated details**

Leo does not simply imagine one object or one small scene. He creates an entire imaginary setting around the toys, with places, situations, characters, and ideas.

繁體中文： ** **完整的；整個的；包含所有相關部分而不是只有一小部分的

**中文翻譯： **

> “He creates whole worlds around them.”

「他會圍繞那些玩具創造出**一整個完整的世界**。」

Here:

whole worlds = 完整、全面發展出來的想像世界，而不是零星的想法

1. **whole = entire / all of something (整個的) — 整個；全部**

This is the exact core sense in your passage.

Practice 1 — Original

> “He creates **whole worlds** around them.”

「他會圍繞那些玩具創造出**一整個世界**。」

Practice 2

> “She spent the **whole afternoon** reading.”

「她花了**整個下午**閱讀。」

Practice 3

> “The **whole family** came to dinner.”

「**全家人**都來吃晚飯。」

whole = 某人 / 某事物的全部，而不是其中一部分

2. **the whole + noun** (整個.....) — 全部；整個

Practice 4

> “I watched the **whole film**.”

「我看完了**整套電影**。」

Practice 5

> “The **whole room** became quiet.”

「**整個房間**都安靜下來。」

the whole + singular noun = 指某個完整事物的全部範圍 / 內容

Notice:

> **the whole book**

> = 整本書

not:

> “whole books” when referring to one complete book.

3. **whole** = complete / with all parts present (完整的) — 完整的；完好無缺的

A closely related but important branch.

Practice 6

> “The vase remained **whole** after the fall.”

「花瓶掉下來後仍然**完整無缺**。」

Practice 7

> “Try to keep the egg **whole**.”

「盡量保持雞蛋**完整**，不要弄破。」

whole = 所有部分仍然存在、沒有破裂、缺失或被分開的

Here the focus is not simply “all of it,” but **physical completeness**.

4. **whole** = not cut/divided (完整未切開的) — 整個的；未切開的

Practice 8

> “Add a **whole onion**.”

「加入**整個洋蔥**。」

Practice 9

> “She ate the **whole apple**.”

「她吃了**整個蘋果**。」

whole = 保持原本完整形態，沒有被切成較小部分的

This overlaps with the “entire” sense but is particularly common with food and physical objects.

5. **whole** = complete in scope/detail (全面的) — 完整的；全面的

This is particularly close to your **whole worlds** usage.

Practice 10

> “The novel creates a **whole universe** of its own.”

「這部小說創造出一個屬於自己的**完整世界**。」

Practice 11

> “There is a **whole system** behind the process.”

「這個過程背後有一套**完整的系統**。」

whole = 包含大量互相連結的部分，形成完整而全面的整體

In your passage, Leo creates not just individual toys, but imagined environments around them.

6. **a whole** + noun = surprisingly large/complete amount (足足一整個) — 整整；足足

Whole can add emphasis.

Practice 12

> “He waited a **whole hour**.”

「他**足足**等了一個小時。」

Practice 13

> “She ate a **whole cake** by herself.”

「她一個人吃掉了**整個蛋糕**。」

a whole + noun = 強調數量、時間或範圍比預期大，或完全沒有減少

So **whole** can have an emphatic pragmatic effect.

7. **the whole thing** (整件事 / 整個東西) — 整件事；全部

Practice 14

> “Tell me the **whole thing**.”

「把**整件事**告訴我。」

Practice 15

> “I had to start the **whole thing** again.”

「我不得不把**整件事**重新做一次。」

the whole thing = 某件事情 / 物件的全部內容，而不是其中一部分

Very common in conversation.

8. **the whole time** (一直 / 整段時間) — 整段時間；一直

Practice 16

> “He knew the answer **the whole time**.”

「他**由頭到尾**一直都知道答案。」

Practice 17

> “She was smiling **the whole time**.”

「她**整段時間**都在笑。」

the whole time = 從開始到結束的整段期間

Close to:

> all the time

but context can make **all the time** mean “very frequently,” whereas **the whole time** clearly means one continuous period.

9. **the whole way** (全程) — 一路上；整段路程

Practice 18

> “The child talked **the whole way home**.”

「那個小朋友**回家全程**都在說話。」

Practice 19

> “It rained the **whole way**.”

「**整段路程**都在下雨。」

the whole way = 從旅程開始到結束的整段路程

10. **the whole of + noun** (.....的全部) — 整個；全部

A slightly more formal construction.

Practice 20

> “She spent the **whole of the afternoon** working.”

「她**整個下午**都在工作。」

Practice 21

> “The storm affected the **whole of the region**.”

「暴風雨影響了**整個地區**。」

the whole of X = X 的全部範圍 / 全部時間

Especially common when the noun already has:

* the

* this

* my

* a place name, etc.

11. **whole** — noun = complete thing/entity (整體) — 整體；整個事物

Now **whole** functions as a noun.

Practice 22

> “The parts form a **whole**.”

「這些部分組成一個**整體**。」

Practice 23

> “The picture only makes sense when viewed as a **whole**.”

「這幅圖只有作為一個**整體**來看才有意思。」

a whole = 由不同部分組成的一個完整整體

12. **as a whole** (整體而言) — 作為整體；整體來說

A very useful expression.

Practice 24

> “The class performed well **as a whole**.”

「這個班級**整體而言**表現良好。」

Practice 25

> “The economy **as a whole** is improving.”

「經濟**整體而言**正在改善。」

as a whole = 把所有部分合在一起看，而不是逐一分析個別部分

13. **on the whole** (總的來說) — 整體而言；總的來說

Practice 26

> “**On the whole**, I enjoyed the trip.”

「**總的來說**，我很享受這趟旅程。」

Practice 27

> “The results were, **on the whole**, positive.”

「**整體而言**，結果是正面的。」

on the whole = 考慮各方面後作出整體評價；總的來說

This is a discourse expression rather than literal “完整.”

14. **a whole lot (很多) — 很多 ; 非常多**

Informal.

Practice 28

> “He has a **whole lot** of questions.”

「他有**很多很多問題**。」

Practice 29

> “That makes a **whole lot** of difference.”

「那會造成**很大的差別**。」

a whole lot (of) = 很大量 / 很大程度 ; 非正式強調語氣

15. **a whole lot + comparative (.....得多) — 大大地 ;很多**

Practice 30

> “This version is a **whole lot better**.”

「這個版本**好得多**。」

Practice 31

> “The new system is a **whole lot easier** to use.”

「新系統**容易用得更多**。」

a whole lot + comparative = 用非正式方式強調程度差距很大

16. **a whole new/different + noun (完全不同 / 全新的) — 全新的 ; 完全不同的**

A very common emphatic pattern.

Practice 32

> “That creates a **whole new problem**.”

「那會產生一個**全新的問題**。」

Practice 33

> “Living abroad is a **whole different experience**.”

「在外國生活是一種**完全不同的體驗**。」

whole + new/different = 強調某事物不只是稍微不同，而是整體上有明顯改變

17. **whole number (整數 / 非負整數) — 整數**

A genuine mathematical term.

Practice 34

> “Three is a **whole number**.”

「三是一個**整數**。」

Practice 35

> “Write the answer as a **whole number**.”

「把答案寫成**整數**。」

whole number = 沒有小數或分數部分的整數；在基礎數學語境通常特指 0、1、2、3.....

Terminology can vary somewhat by curriculum, but this is the usual school-level use.

18. **whole food (天然完整食物) — 未高度加工的食物**

Practice 36

> “The diet focuses on **whole foods**.”

「這種飲食方式以**天然、少加工的完整食物**為主。」

Practice 37

> “Fruit, vegetables, and grains can be **whole foods**.”

「水果、蔬菜和穀物都可以屬於**天然完整食物**。」

whole food = 保持接近天然原貌、加工程度較低的食物

This is an established nutritional compound.

19. **whole grain** (全穀物) — 全穀；全穀物的

Practice 38

> “Choose **whole-grain** bread.”

「選擇**全穀麵包**。」

Practice 39

> “Brown rice is a **whole grain**.”

「糙米是一種**全穀物**。」

whole grain = 保留麩皮、胚芽及胚乳等主要部分的穀物

The idea is literally that the grain remains relatively **whole/complete**.

20. **whole milk** (全脂奶) — 全脂牛奶

Practice 40

> “The recipe uses **whole milk**.”

「這個食譜使用**全脂牛奶**。」

Practice 41

> “Some children prefer **whole milk**.”

「有些小朋友比較喜歡**全脂奶**。」

****whole milk = 沒有像低脂 / 脫脂奶那樣移除大部分脂肪的牛奶****

Here ****whole**** has a specialized food-label meaning.

21. ****make someone/something whole (恢復完整) — 使恢復完整；彌補****

A figurative/formal expression.

Practice 42

> “The compensation was intended to ****make the customer whole****.”

「這筆賠償旨在令顧客的損失得到****完全彌補****。」

Practice 43

> “She felt that something was missing before she finally felt ****whole**** again.”

「她以前總覺得缺少了甚麼，後來才重新感到自己****完整了****。」

****make/be whole = 恢復完整、完整感或原有狀態；在法律 / 金融語境可指充分彌補損失****

22. ****whole = emotionally complete/integrated (內在完整的) — 完整的；完整自足的****

A figurative psychological/literary use.

Practice 44

> “She finally felt ****whole**** again.”

「她終於再次感到自己是****完整的****。」

Practice 45

> “The experience helped him feel more ****whole****.”

「這段經歷令他感到自己的內在更加****完整****。」

****whole = 在情感、心理或身份上感到完整、沒有某部分缺失****

This is more abstract/literary than ordinary ****entire****.

23. **wholly = completely (完全地) — 完全 ; 全然**

The main adverbial family form.

Practice 46

> “The decision was **wholly** unexpected.”

「這個決定**完全**出乎意料。」

Practice 47

> “The project is **wholly** funded by donations.”

「這個項目**完全**由捐款資助。」

wholly = completely / entirely ; 完全地

Register:

> somewhat formal

24. **wholly owned (全資擁有) — 全資的**

A common business/legal collocation.

Practice 48

> “It is a **wholly owned** subsidiary.”

「它是一間**全資附屬公司**。」

Practice 49

> “The company is **wholly owned** by its parent group.”

「這間公司由母公司**全資擁有**。」

wholly owned = 所有股權 / 所有權完全由一個實體持有

25. **wholeness = state of being complete (完整性) — 完整；整體感**

Practice 50

> “The design has a sense of **wholeness**.”

「這個設計帶有一種**完整統一感**。」

Practice 51

> “She wanted to regain a sense of **wholeness**.”

「她希望重新找回一種內在的**完整感**。」

wholeness = 各部分完整結合、沒有缺失的狀態；亦可指心理上的完整感

26. **wholehearted = fully sincere/enthusiastic (全心全意的) — 全心全意的；真誠投入的**

A useful lexical extension.

Practice 52

> “She gave the idea her **wholehearted support**.”

「她對這個想法給予**全心全意的支持**。」

Practice 53

> “He showed **wholehearted enthusiasm** for the project.”

「他對這個項目表現出**全情投入的熱情**。」

wholehearted = 完全真誠、毫無保留地投入或支持的

The metaphor is:

> one's **whole heart** → complete commitment.

27. **wholeheartedly = completely and sincerely (全心全意地) — 真心地；全力地**

Practice 54

> “I **wholeheartedly agree**.”

「我**完全 / 衷心同意**。」

Practice 55

> “She **wholeheartedly supported** the plan.”

「她**全心全意地支持**這個計劃。」

wholeheartedly = 以完全真誠、毫無保留的態度

Important distinction: **whole** vs **all**

This is the most important grammar contrast.

whole

usually modifies a **singular countable noun**:

> **the whole book**

= 整本書

all

is more flexible:

> **all the book** — possible in limited contexts but less natural

> **all the books** = 所有書

> **all the water** = 所有水

For one complete singular object:

> **the whole book**

is usually much more natural.

Important distinction: **whole** vs **entire**

These are extremely close.

whole

more common and conversational:

> “the whole day”

entire

slightly stronger/formal in many contexts:

> “the entire day”

Both mean:

> 整整一天

But **whole** has additional uses such as:

* whole number

* whole milk

* feel whole

where **entire** cannot simply replace it.

Important distinction: **whole vs complete**

whole

emphasizes:

> all parts together / not divided.

complete

often emphasizes:

> nothing missing or unfinished.

Compare:

> “a whole cake”

= 整個蛋糕

> “a complete report”

= 完整、所有部分都寫好的報告

There is overlap, but they are not always interchangeable.

Important distinction: **whole vs total**

whole

usually describes one complete entity.

total

often emphasizes:

> combined amount or sum.

> “the whole family”

= 整個家庭

> “the total cost”

= 總成本

So **total family** would not normally replace **whole family**.

Important distinction: **whole vs intact**

whole

can mean complete/not broken.

intact

more specifically means:

> not damaged, altered, or broken despite something that might have harmed it.

> “The vase remained intact.”

is often more precise than:

> “The vase remained whole.”

Important distinction: **whole world vs entire world**

Both can literally mean:

> 全世界

But in your passage:

> **whole worlds**

means complete **imaginary worlds**, plural.

It emphasizes how fully developed Leo's imagination is.

> **entire worlds**

would also be possible, but **whole worlds** sounds natural and vivid.

Important distinction: **a whole world vs the whole world**

a whole world

= one complete world, often figurative:

> “A whole world opened up to her.”

= 一個全新的世界向她展開。

the whole world

= the entire world / everyone everywhere:

> “The whole world knows.”

= 全世界都知道。

Article choice changes the interpretation.

Important distinction: **whole = complete vs whole = emphasis**

Compare:

> “He ate the whole cake.”

Literal completeness:

= 整個蛋糕都吃了。

> “He waited a whole hour.”

The core completeness remains, but **whole** also emphasizes:

= 足足等了一小時。

So the second has stronger pragmatic emphasis.

Important distinction: **as a whole vs on the whole**

This is crucial.

as a whole

= considering something as one complete unit.

> “The class as a whole did well.”

= 整個班級作為整體表現良好。

on the whole

= generally / overall.

> “On the whole, the class did well.”

= 總的來說，班級表現良好。

They are related but not interchangeable.

Important distinction: **whole vs wholesome**

These look related, but modern learner meaning has diverged.

whole

= complete / entire.

wholesome

= healthy, morally positive, beneficial, or good for well-being.

> “wholesome food”

= 健康有益的食物

> “wholesome entertainment”

= 健康正面的娛樂

For this project, I would **not treat wholesome as a simple derivative meaning of whole**. It is better curated separately if encountered.

Important distinction: **whole vs wholesale**

Likewise:

wholesale

now means:

> selling goods in large quantities, typically to retailers

or figuratively:

> large-scale / extensive.

Despite the visible **whole-** element, it has become a separate lexical item.

I would **not fold wholesale into the ordinary whole family** for learner-facing curation.

Important distinction: **whole number vs integer**

In school mathematics:

whole number

usually:

> 0, 1, 2, 3, ...

integer

includes:

> ..., -2, -1, 0, 1, 2, ...

So technically:

> all whole numbers are integers,

but:

> negative integers are not normally called whole numbers.

Important distinction: **whole food vs whole meal**

whole food

= minimally processed food in near-natural form.

whole meal

= an entire meal.

Here **whole** has different structures:

> whole food = established nutritional compound

> whole meal = adjective "entire."

Important distinction: **whole vs wholly**

whole

adjective:

> “the whole story”

wholly

adverb:

> “wholly unacceptable”

= 完全不能接受

Do not use:

> “whole unacceptable” ❌

Important distinction: **wholly vs fully**

Both can mean 「完全」.

wholly

often sounds more formal and emphasizes totality:

> wholly inappropriate

fully

often emphasizes completeness of degree/state:

> fully prepared

Their collocations differ.

Important distinction: **whole vs wholeness**

whole

describes something complete or can mean an entire entity.

wholeness

is the abstract state/quality:

> completeness, integration, unity.

> “a sense of wholeness”

= 一種完整感。

Family-extension note

Whole is a strong moderate polysemy/grammar candidate.

Its central semantic idea is:

> **all parts together, with nothing excluded or missing**

From that concept come several useful branches:

- * **entire amount/entity** → the whole family
- * **complete/not broken** → remain whole
- * **fully developed scope** → a whole world/system
- * **emphatic totality** → a whole hour
- * **noun: an integrated whole**
- * **as a whole** → 作為整體
- * **on the whole** → 總的來說
- * **technical whole number**
- * **specialized whole foods / whole milk**
- * **psychological/literary whole** → feel whole

The family sweep adds:

- * **wholly**
- * **wholeness**
- * **wholehearted**
- * **wholeheartedly**

But **wholesome** and **wholesale** have developed sufficiently independent modern meanings that I would not automatically merge them into this learner-facing family merely because they share historical/formal material. That follows the manual's instruction to include useful family extensions while preserving modern lexical identity accurately.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
-----	-----
whole — entire	某人 / 某事物的全部，而不是其中一部分
the whole + noun	某個完整事物的全部範圍 / 內容
whole — intact/complete	所有部分仍存在，沒有破裂、缺失或分開
whole — uncut/undivided	保持原本完整形態，沒有被分成較小部分
whole — complete in scope	包含所有相關部分，形成全面而完整的整體
a whole + noun — emphasis	強調整個數量、時間或範圍；足足 / 整整
the whole thing	某件事情 / 物件的全部內容
the whole time	從開始到結束的整段時間
the whole way	旅程由開始到結束的全部路程
the whole of X	X 的全部範圍或期間
a whole — noun	由不同部分組成的一個完整整體
as a whole	把所有部分合在一起作為一個整體來看
on the whole	綜合各方面而言；總的來說
a whole lot	很大量 / 很大程度；非正式強調
a whole lot + comparative	強調程度差距很大；……得多
a whole new/different X	全新 / 整體上完全不同的 X
whole number	沒有分數 / 小數部分的非負整數
whole food	保持接近天然原貌、加工程度較低的食物
whole grain	保留主要天然組成部分的全穀物
whole milk	沒有移除大部分天然乳脂的全脂牛奶
make/be whole	恢復完整狀態、完整感或充分彌補損失
whole — emotional	在心理 / 身份上感到完整、沒有缺失
wholly	完全地；全然
wholeness	各部分完整結合、沒有缺失的狀態 / 完整感
wholehearted	完全真誠、毫無保留地投入或支持的
wholeheartedly	以完全真誠、全心投入的方式

For your original sentence

> “He does not just play with toys; he creates **whole worlds** around them.”

The exact meaning is:

whole = 完整的、全面形成的，而不是只有零散部分的

Therefore:

> **whole worlds**

= **「一整個又一整個完整的想像世界」**

The important nuance is that Leo does not merely say:

> “This Lego is a rocket.”

Instead, his imagination develops:

- > places
- > roles
- > environments
- > events
- > connections between objects

So **whole** emphasizes the **scale and completeness of his imagination**.

It is the same underlying completeness concept as:

> **the whole book** = 整本書

but here it has a more vivid creative effect:

> **isolated toy → complete imagined world**

That is why **whole worlds** is stronger than simply:

> **imaginary scenes**.